VITALITY 04

Oxytocin

Nine-amino-acid peptide hormone from the pituitary gland; the medicine form is synthetic



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Peptide hormone	Labor; sexual response in men	FDA approved (labor); small studies in men	FDA approved (Pitocin); men off-label

STUDIED FOR

- **Labor and after birth** — HUMAN
- **Sexual experience** — HUMAN
- **Ejaculation timing** — HUMAN
- **Mating behavior** — ANIMAL

All studies in men used a nasal spray. No human study of oxytocin by mouth, strip, troche or gummy was found. Use for male sexual function is off-label.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Oxytocin ▶ OT receptors ▶ Calcium in cells ▶ Uterus contracts

- **Binds its receptors** in the womb and raises calcium in muscle cells
- **Holds water** in the kidneys; its structure is close to vasopressin
- **In male rats,** brain oxytocin increased mating (animal research)
- **In men,** an effect on sexual function is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- FDA approved only for labor and after birth
- 5 small studies in men, mostly one dose
- No Phase II or III trial in men

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Effect on sexual function in men
- Side effects in men
- Oral, strip or gummy forms
- Long-term use in men

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
About 1 to 6 minutes in blood (label)	Vein or muscle injection (label); nasal spray in men's studies
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Removed from blood mainly by the kidney and liver	Rx injection (Pitocin, generics); compounded forms unapproved
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Contractions, water balance, blood pressure (label, in labor)	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved injection for labor (Pitocin); not for men
FDA	Nasal spray approval withdrawn in 1997
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Pitocin prescribing information (DailyMed), May 2026
2. Behnia et al., Horm Behav, oxytocin in couples, Mar 2014
3. Burri et al., Psychoneuroendocrinology, oxytocin and sexual arousal, Jun 2008

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